



UNIVERSITÀ DEGLI STUDI
DI MILANO

Visione Artificiale

Raffaella Lanzarotti

Where are we?

First part:

Image formation and Early vision

- Image formation
 - Geometric Camera Models
 - Color spaces
- Image Processing
 - Punctual and spatial processing
 - Feature Extraction
- Reconstruction
 - Camera calibration
 - Stereo Vision
 - Structure from Motion and RGB-d Cameras
- Optical flow
- **Tracking**

Second part:

Machine learning for CV

- Linear Neural Network
- Multi Layer Perceptron
- Convolutional Neural Networks
- Recurrent Neural Networks
- Transformers
- Variational Auto-Encoders
- Generative Adversarial Networks
- Graph Neural Networks
- Self-supervised learning
- Vision Language Models

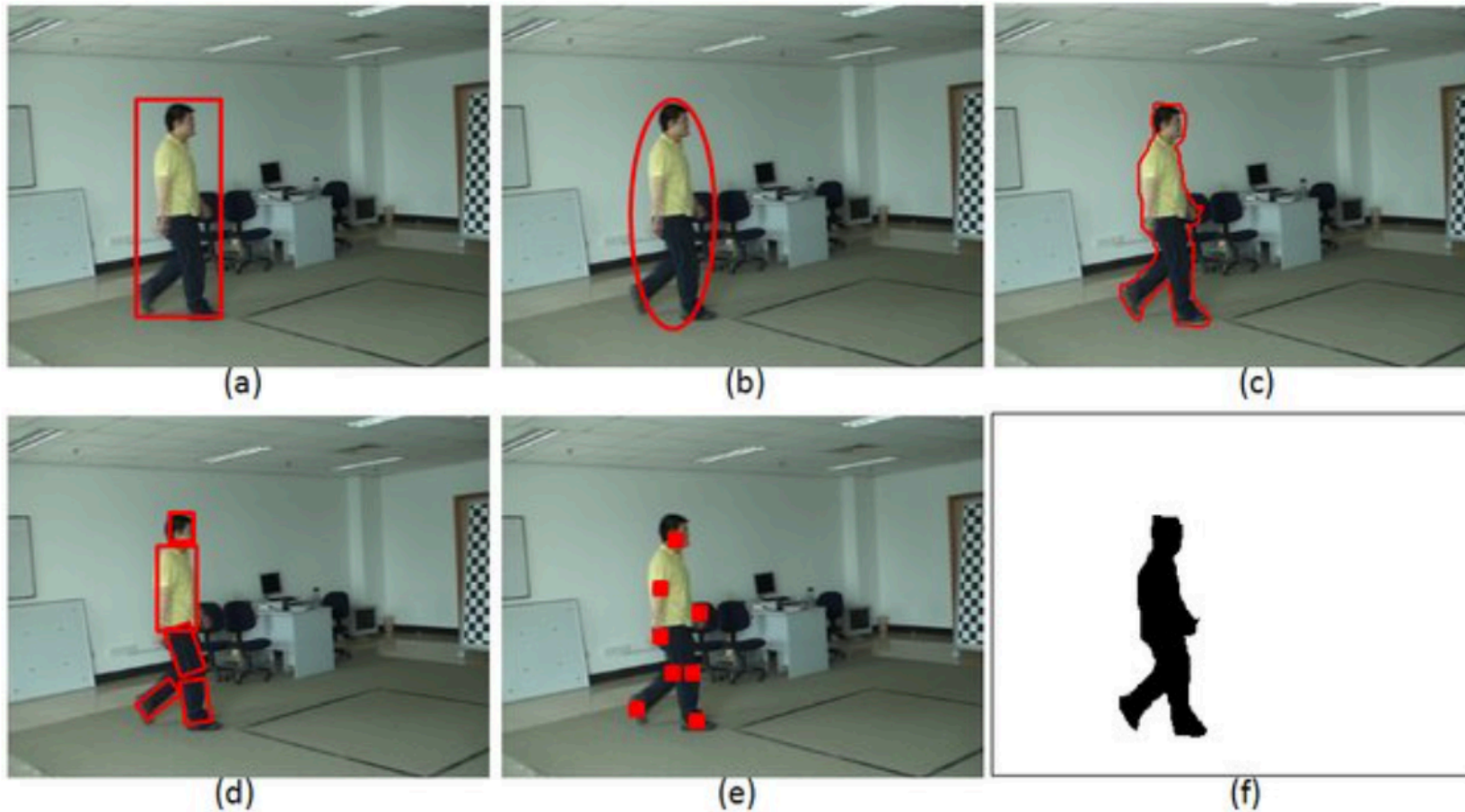
TRACKING

Tracking

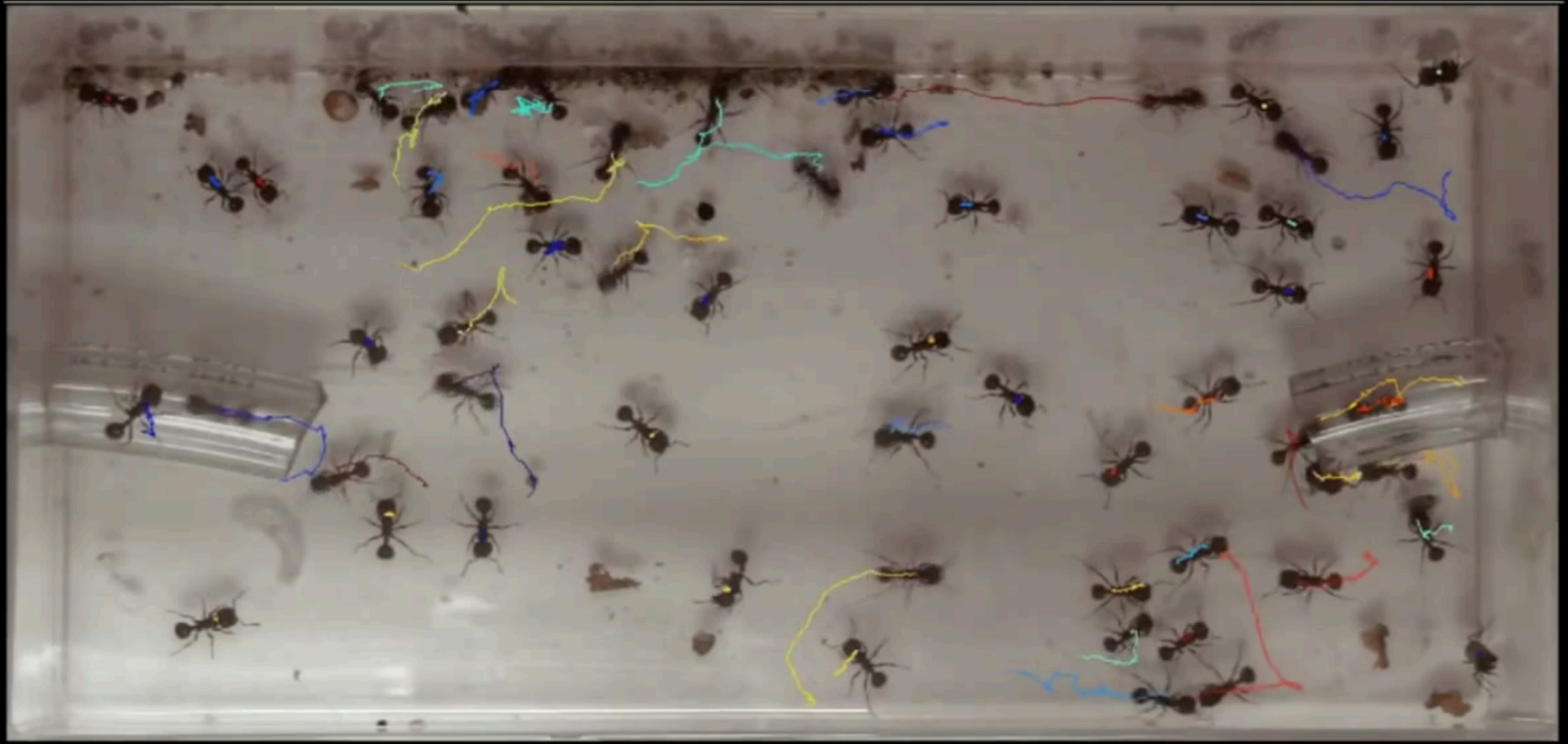
Estimating the trajectory of objects moving in a scene

- Modalities:
 - single/multiple object tracking
 - single/moving/multiple cameras
- Challenges:
 - illumination changes
 - shape changes
 - occlusions
- Currently:
 - very active research field
(<https://www.votchallenge.net/vot2018/trackers.html>)
 - auto tracking camera (<https://1beyond.com/autotracker>)

Single Object Tracking



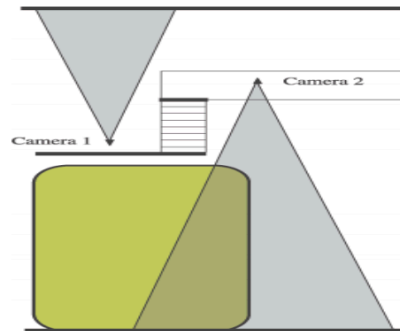
Multiple Object Tracking



Multiple fixed & Overlapping camera tracking



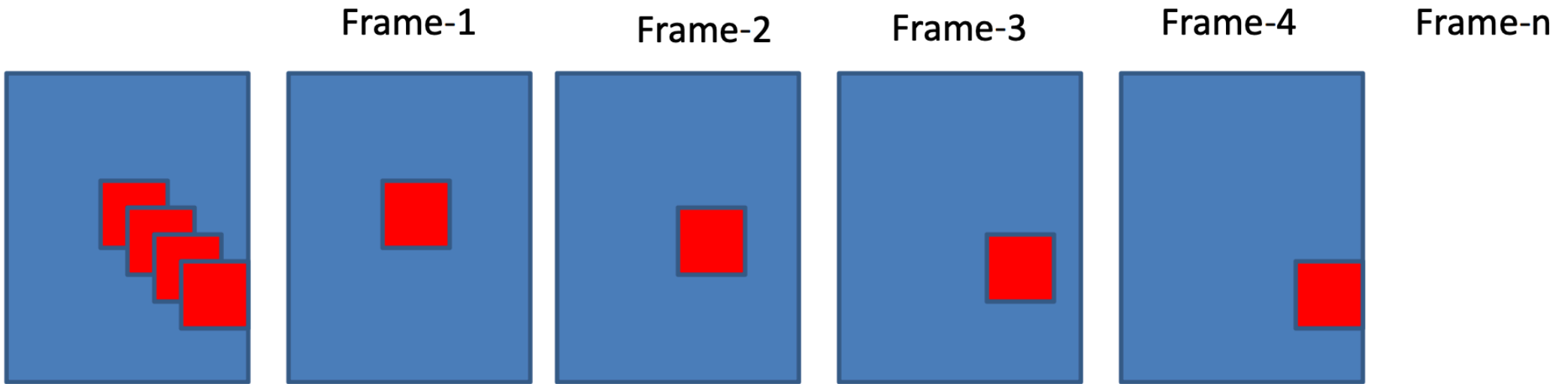
Multiple fixed & Non-overlapping camera tracking



TODAY

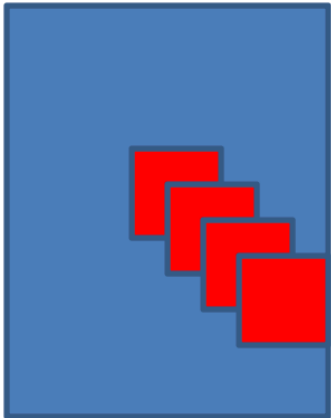
FEATURE-BASED MOTION TRACKING

Single object motion

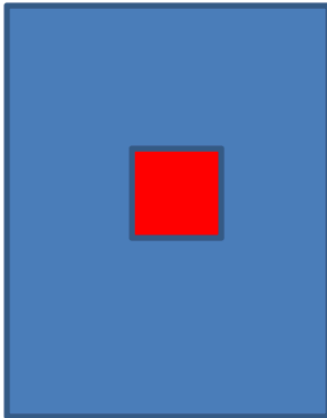


Single object motion

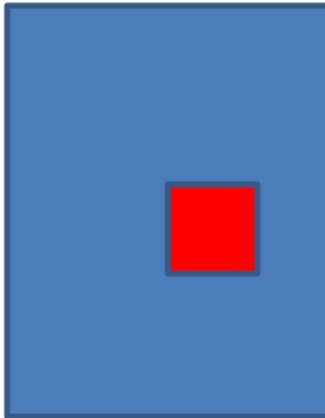
Frame-1



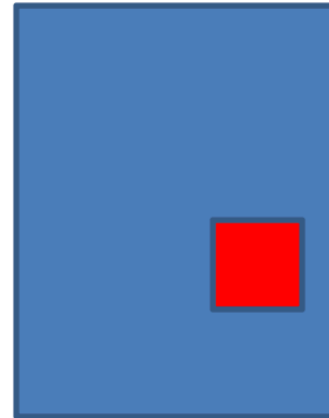
Frame-2



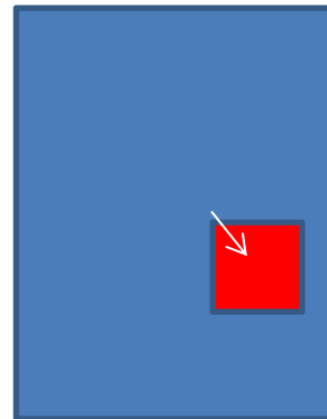
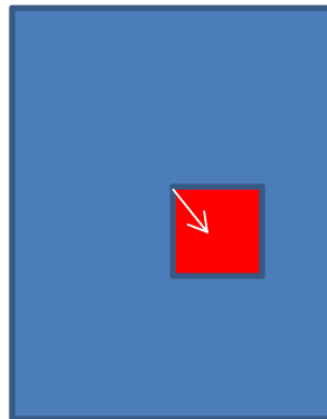
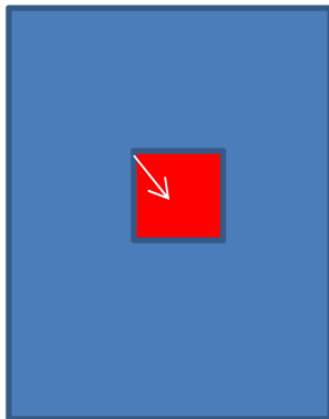
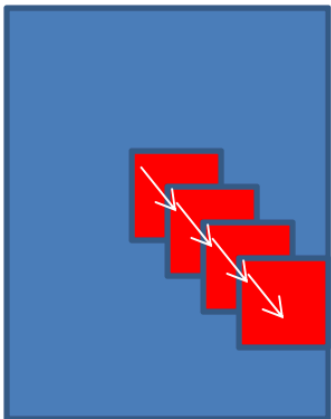
Frame-3



Frame-4



Frame-n



Feature-based motion tracking

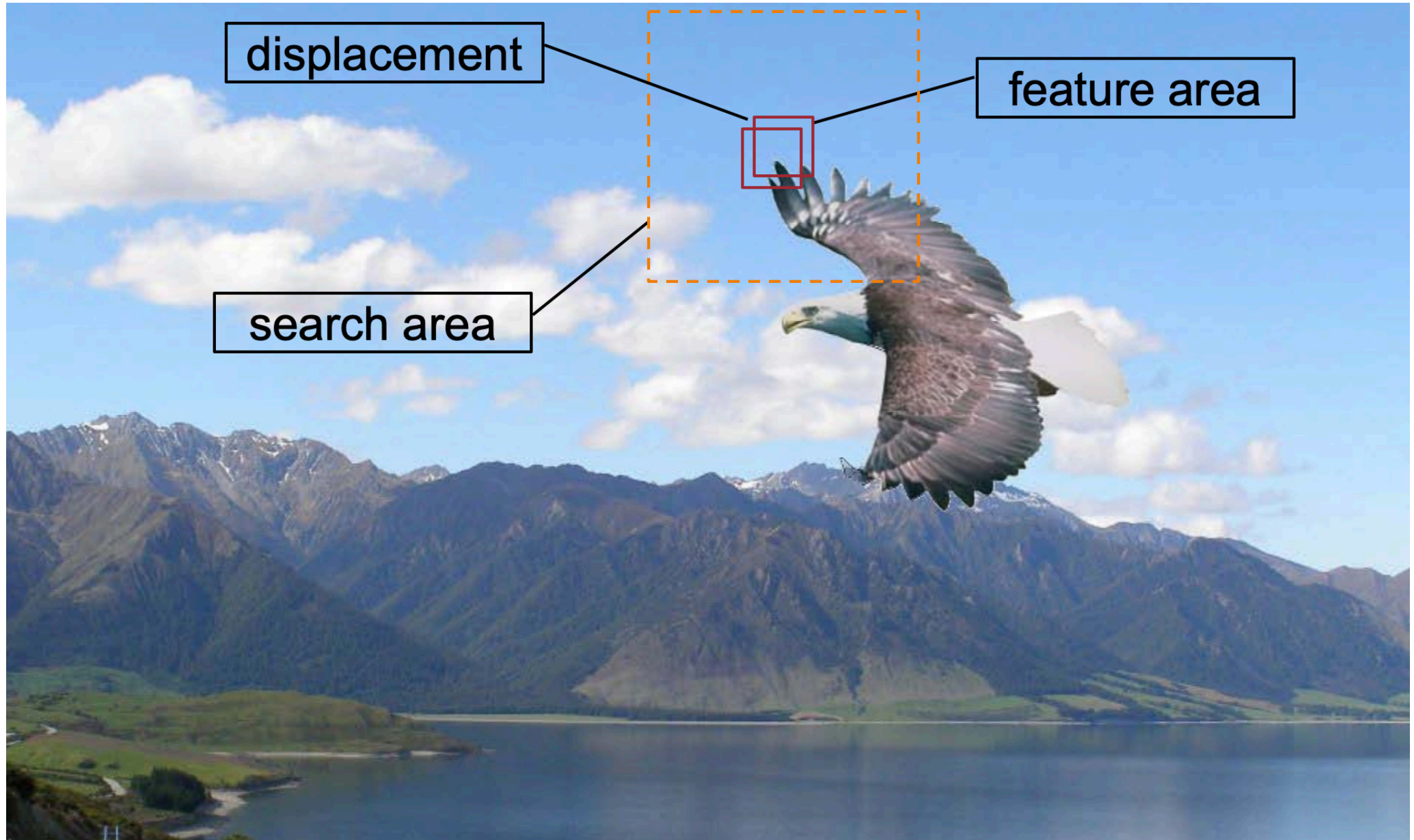
- Look for distinct features that change positions



- the eagle's wings change position
- the mountains do not change position

KLT (Kanade-Lucas-Tomasi) tracking

Basic idea



KLT (Kanade-Lucas-Tomasi) tracking

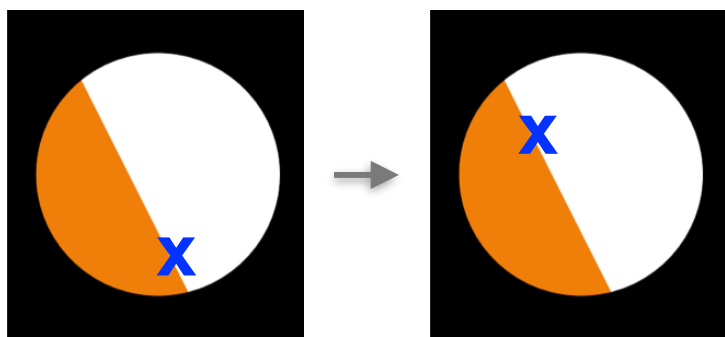
Basic idea

1. Look for distinct features in current frame
2. For each feature:
 - Search for matching feature within neighborhood in next frame using Lucas-Kanade OF
 - Difference in positions $\rightarrow$ displacement.
 - $\text{Velocity} = \text{displacement} / \text{time difference}.$

First question: which features?

J. Shi and C. Tomasi. Good Features to Track. CVPR 1994

- Let recall the aperture problem



Edge points 



Corner points 

- Good features to track:

- Harris corners: $R = \lambda_1 \lambda_2 - \alpha(\lambda_1 + \lambda_2)^2$

- **Shi Tomasi feature:** $R = \min(\lambda_1, \lambda_2)$

Second question: which neighborhood?

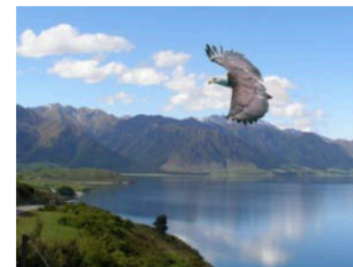
- LK assumes d small
- this implies the search window W is small too



LKT tracker works well only
for small displacements

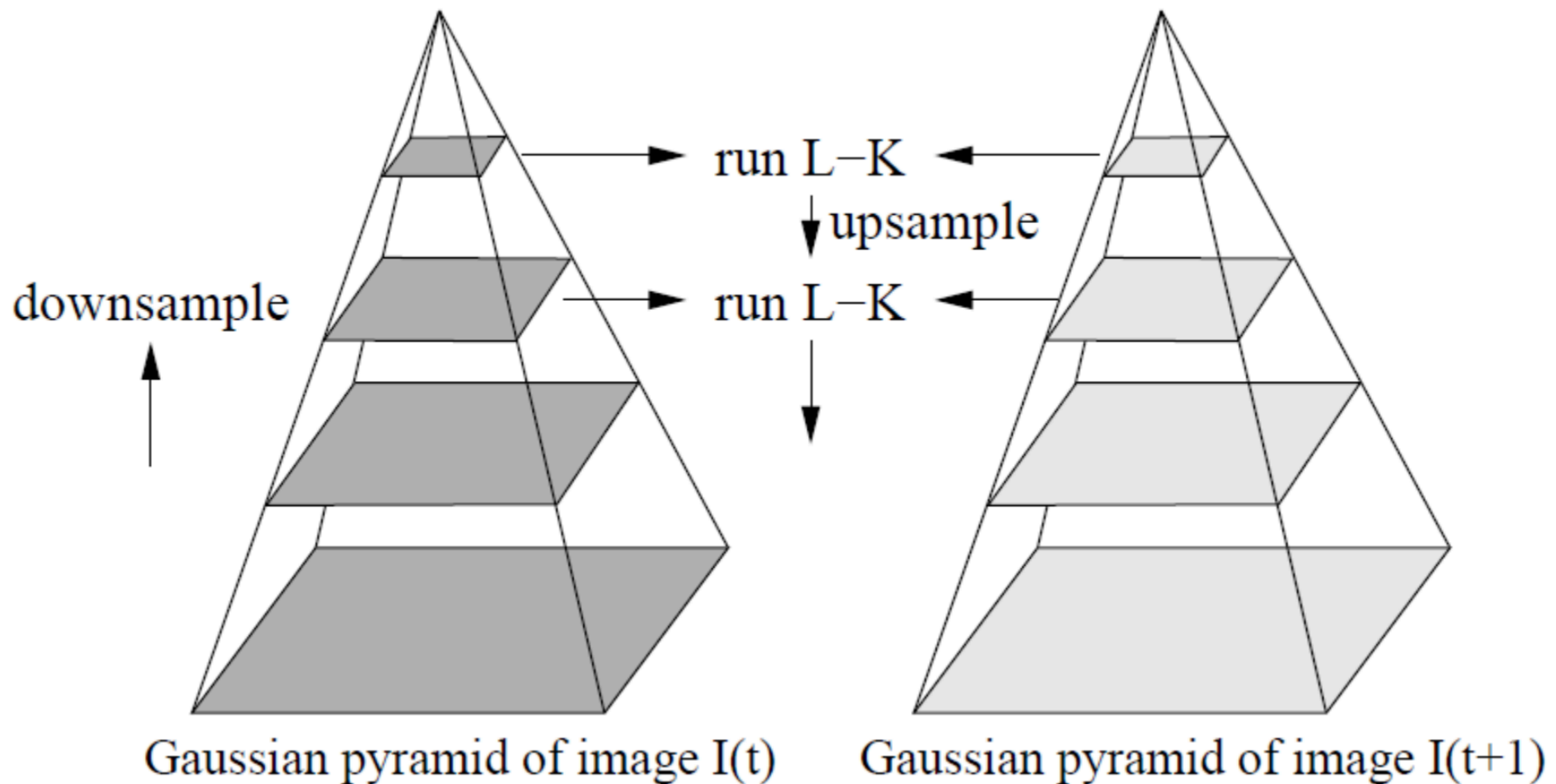
How to handle large displacements?

- Scaling down the image makes the displacements small!



How to handle large displacements?

- LKT using image pyramid



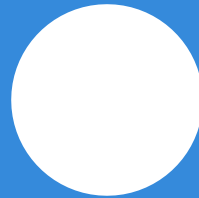
LKT tracker algorithm

- Construct the image pyramids
- detect features (Shi-Tomasi) at the lowest-resolution images
- proceed with a coarse-to-fine search:
 - find displacements at resolution j
 - propagate the result to resolution $j + 1$
 - refine tracking at resolution $j + 1$
 - stop at original resolution
- when long tracks, check appearance of the new patches against the original ones, to detect drifted points

TRACKING WITH DYNAMICS

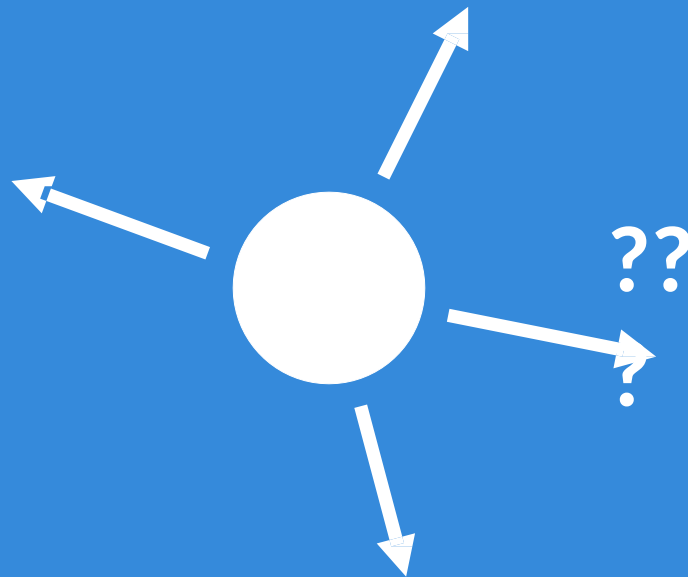
Why do we need to predict

Given an image of a ball,
can you predict where it will go next?



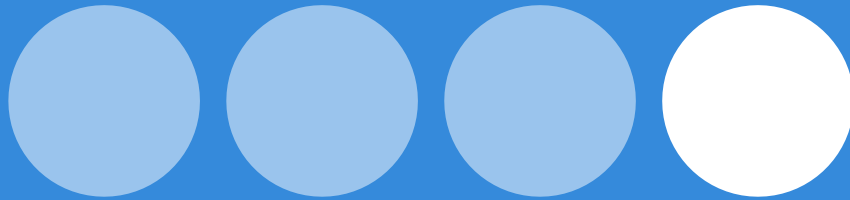
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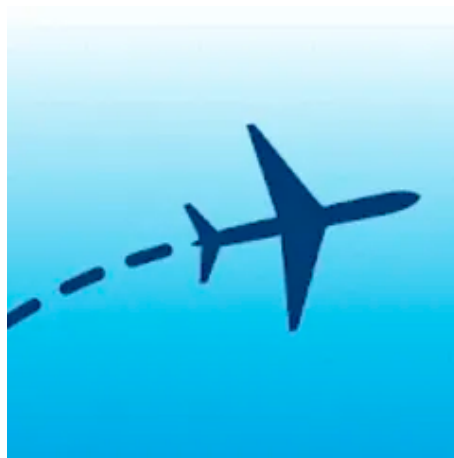


Why do we need to predict

Given an image of a ball,
can you predict where it will go next?



Why do we need to predict



- Suppose we want to estimate the airplane position.
- one way: use sensors such as radar (measurements Z)
- problem: measurements are affected by noise (and occlusions)
- estimation improved using prediction based on dynamics and tracking algorithms

Tracking with dynamics

Key idea:

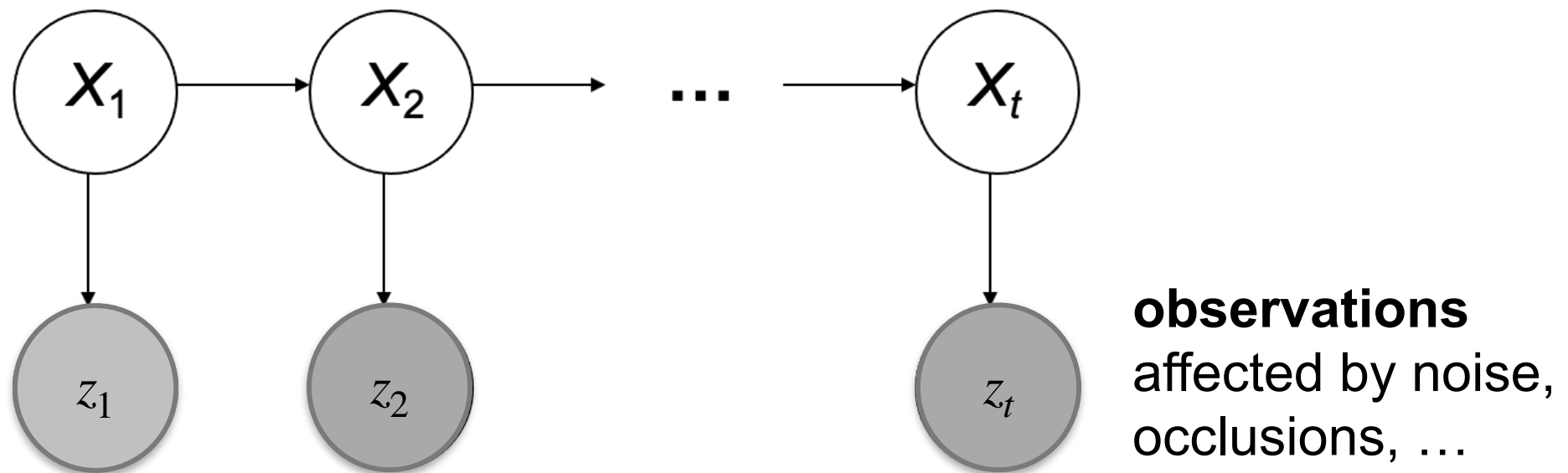
Given a *model of expected motion*, predict where objects will occur in next frame, even before seeing the image

Advantages:

- *Restrict search* for the object
- *Improved estimates since measurement noise is reduced by trajectory smoothness*

General model for tracking

- The moving object of interest is characterized by an **underlying state X**
- State X gives rise to ***measurements or observations Z***
- At each time i , the state changes to X_i and we get a new observation z_i



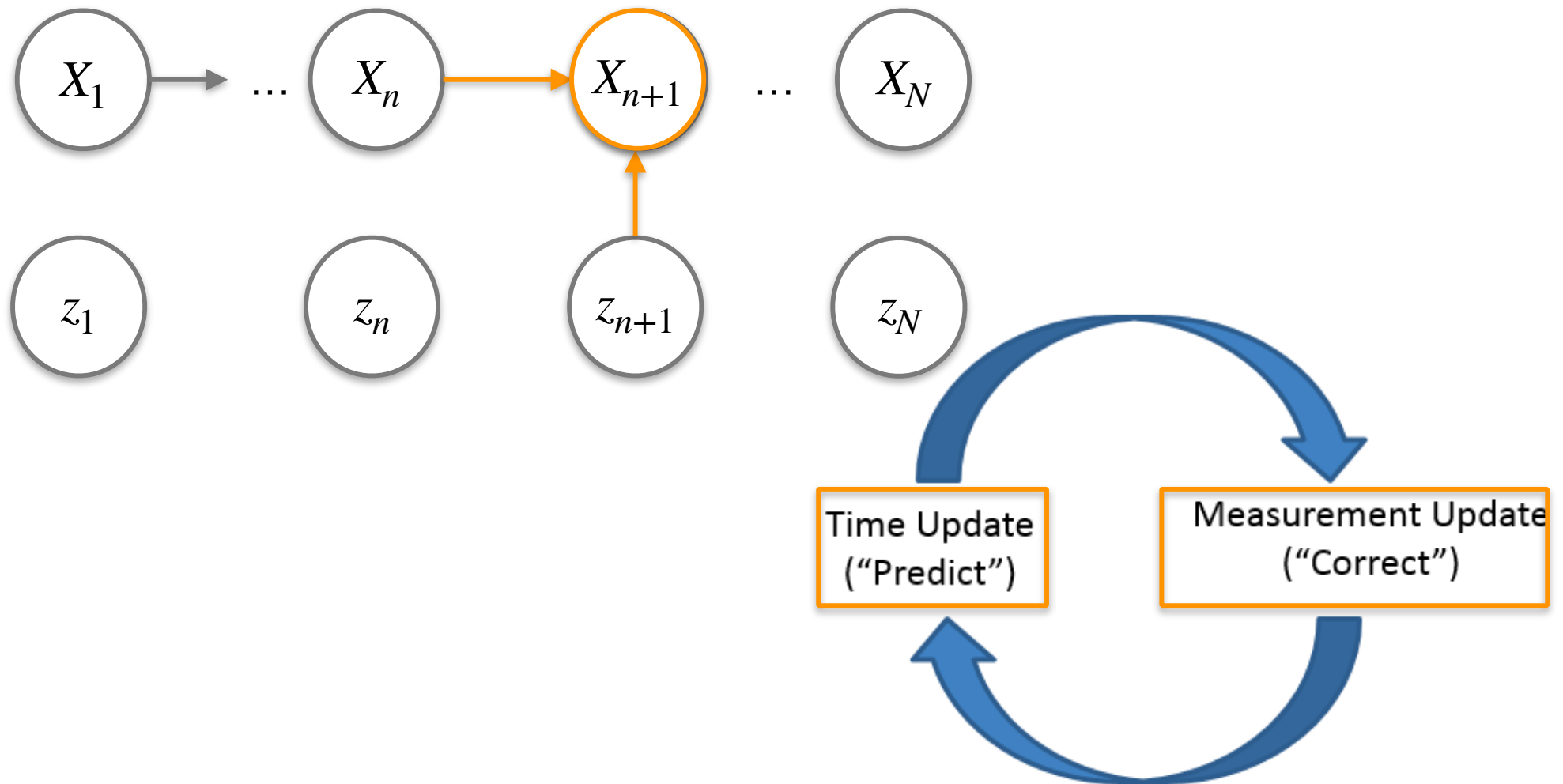
Goal: deduce the underlying **State**

Kalman filter

- **"Measure, Update, Predict" algorithm:** produces estimates of hidden variables X based on inaccurate and uncertain measurements Z
- **Linear dynamic system:** linear prediction of the future system state based on past estimations
- treats measurements, current state estimation, and next state estimation (predictions) as **normally distributed random variables**

Reference:
tutorial

Measure, Update, Predict algorithm



State

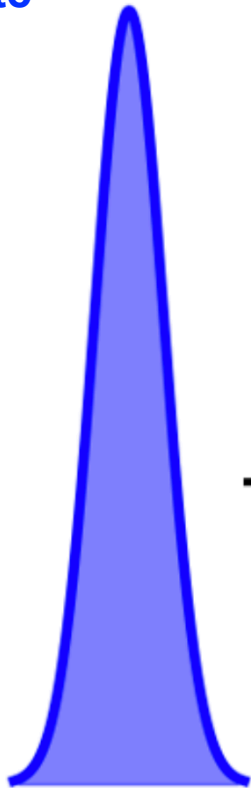
- The state is modeled as a normal distribution:
 - x : true state
 - $\hat{x}_{n,n}$: estimate of x at time n
(having seen the observation z_n)
 - $\hat{x}_{n,n-1}$: prior prediction of x at time n
(NOT having seen the observation z_n)
 - $p_{n,n}$: estimate uncertainty at time n

Prediction step

**Current State
Estimate**

$$\hat{x}_{n-1,n-1}$$

$$P_{n-1,n-1}$$



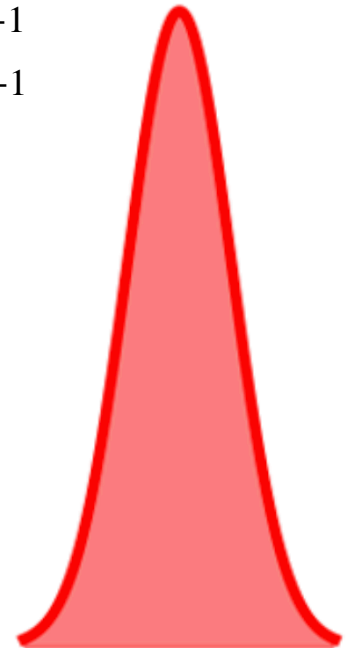
Predict
(Dynamic Model)



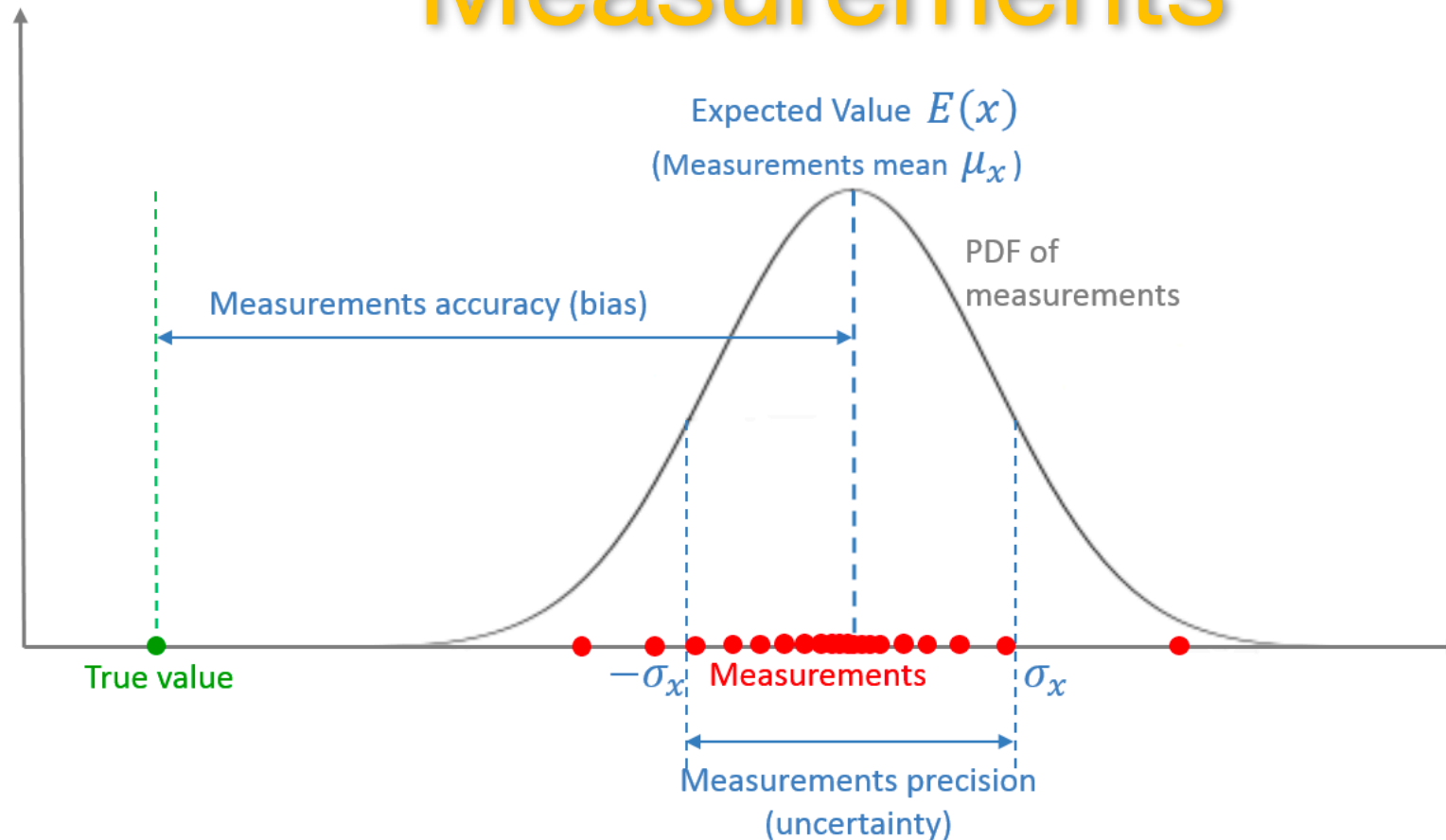
**Prior State
Estimate**

$$\hat{x}_{n,n-1}$$

$$P_{n,n-1}$$



Measurements

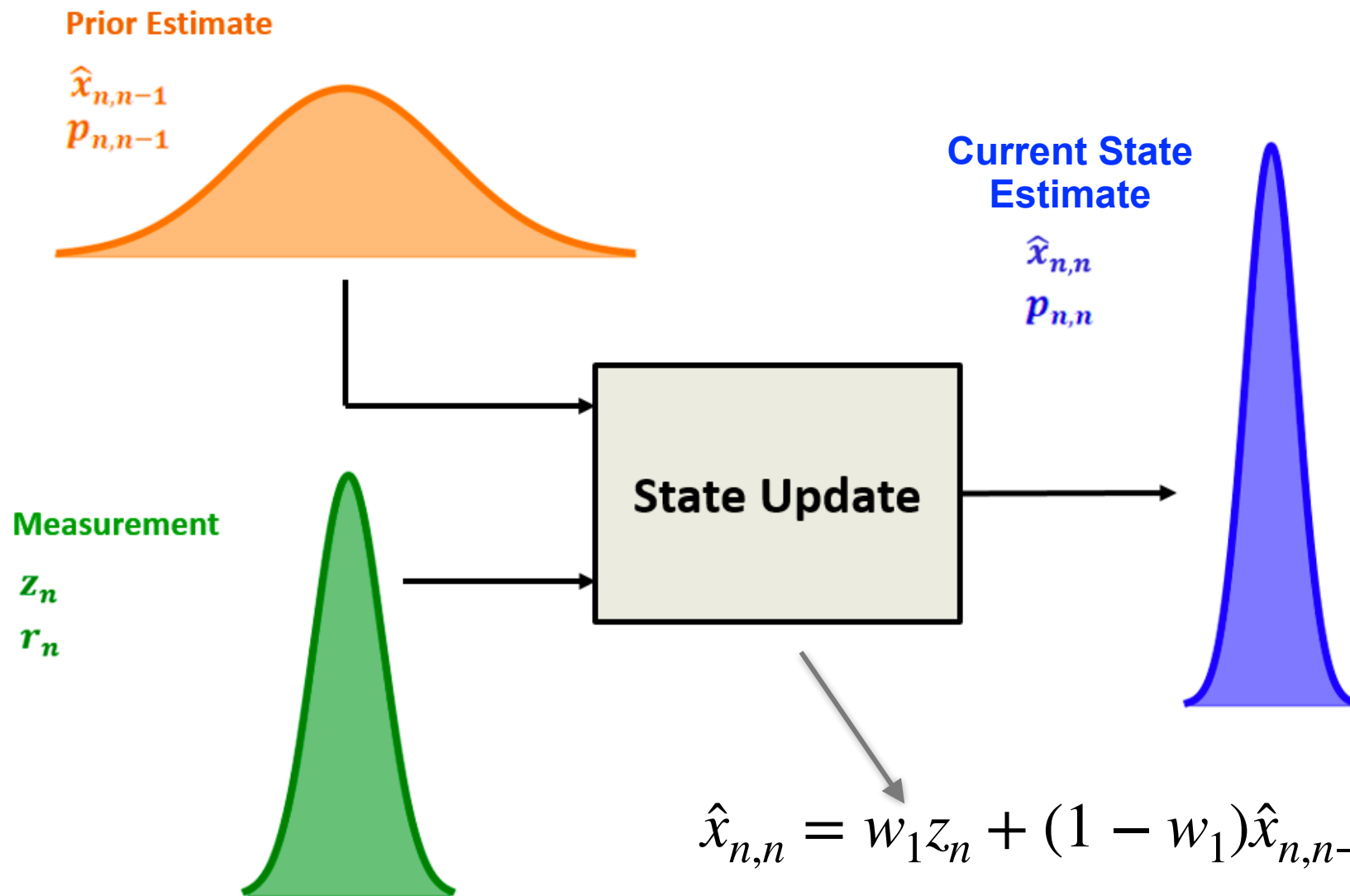


- A measurement is a **random variable**, described by the **Prob. Density Function (PDF)**
- The mean of the measurements is the **Expected Value** of the random variable
- The offset between the mean of the measurements and the true value is the **measurements accuracy**, or **bias**
- The dispersion (variance) of the distribution is the **measurement uncertainty**

Measurements

- The measurement is modeled as a normal distribution:
 - z_n : n -th measurement
 - r_n : measurement uncertainty

State Update

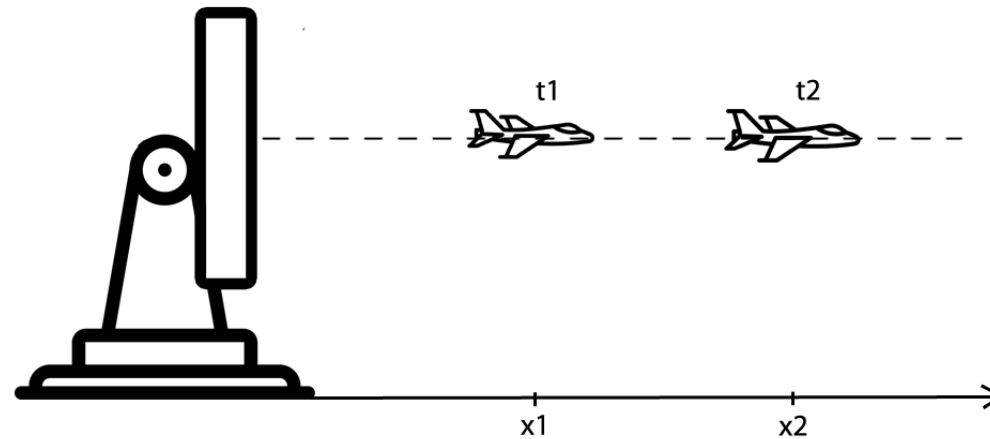


$$\hat{x}_{n,n} = w_1 z_n + (1 - w_1) \hat{x}_{n,n-1}$$

$$p_{n,n} = (1 - w_1) p_{n,n-1}$$

Example:

Tracking 1D with constant velocity



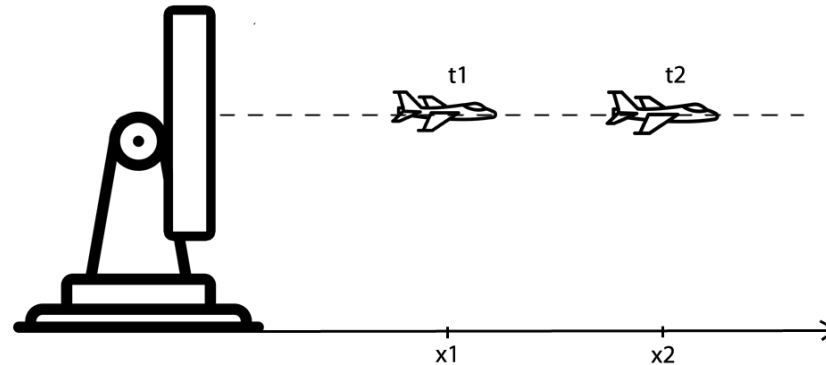
[aircraft moving horizontally]

- system dynamic model for constant velocity motion:

$$x_{t+1} = x_t + \delta t \cdot v_{t+1}$$

$$v_{t+1} = v_t$$

Prediction step



- Prediction equations exploit the system dynamic model. In this case:

$$x_{n+1,n} = x_{n,n} + \Delta t \dot{x}_{n,n}$$

$$\dot{x}_{n+1,n} = \dot{x}_{n,n}$$

where x_n is the position at time n , and $\dot{x} = \frac{dx}{dt}$ is the velocity

Estimate of uncertainty

- p^x : position estimate uncertainty
- p^v : velocity estimate uncertainty

Applying the rule:

$$V(x) = \Delta t^2 V(v)$$

or

$$\sigma_x^2 = \Delta t^2 \sigma_v^2$$

Where:

x is the displacement of the body

v is the velocity of the body

$\Delta(t)$ is the time interval

- the estimation uncertainty extrapolation is:

$$p_{n+1,n}^x = p_{n,n}^x + \Delta t^2 p_{n,n}^v + q_n$$

$$p_{n+1,n}^v = p_{n,n}^v + q_n$$

q_n : Process Noise
Variance: $N(0, q_n)$

The expectation of the body position variance (proof)

$$V(x) = \sigma_x^2 = E(x^2) - \mu_x^2 =$$

$$E((v\Delta t)^2) - (\mu_v \Delta t)^2 =$$

$$E(v^2 \Delta t^2) - \mu_v^2 \Delta t^2 =$$

$$\Delta t^2 E(v^2) - \mu_v^2 \Delta t^2 =$$

$$\Delta t^2 (E(v^2) - \mu_v^2) =$$

$$\Delta t^2 V(v)$$

Express the body position variance in terms of time and velocity $x = \Delta t v$

Apply the rule: $E(ax) = aE(x)$

Apply the rule: $V(x) = E(x^2) - \mu_x^2$

Correction: State update step

Given the prediction and the measurement,
make a weighted combination of them using w_1 and w_2

- $\hat{x}_{n,n} = w_1 z_n + w_2 \hat{x}_{n,n-1}, \quad w_1 + w_2 = 1$

$$\hat{x}_{n,n} = w_1 z_n + (1 - w_1) \hat{x}_{n,n-1}$$

- $p_{n,n} = w_1^2 r_n + (1 - w_1)^2 p_{n,n-1}$

Kalman Filter: optimal filter

- it combines the prior state estimate with the measurement in a way that **minimizes the uncertainty** of the current state estimate.

- GOAL: $\operatorname{argmin}_{w_1} \{p_{n,n}\} \rightarrow \frac{d}{dw_1} p_{n,n} = 0$

$$w_1 = \frac{p_{n,n-1}}{p_{n,n-1} + r_n}$$

Kalman Gain
 K_n

derived on Tablet

Correction: State update step (cont.)

$$\hat{x}_{n,n} = w_1 z_n + (1 - w_1) \hat{x}_{n,n-1} =$$

$$= \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + w_1 (z_n - \hat{x}_{n,n-1}) =$$

$$= \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + K_n (z_n - \hat{x}_{n,n-1})$$


PRIOR


Kalman Gain


INNOVATION

Correction: State update step (cont.)

$$\hat{x}_{n,n} = \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + K_n (z_n - \hat{x}_{n,n-1}) = (1 - K_n) \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + K_n z_n$$

- K_n : measurement weight
- $(1 - K_n)$: weight of the current state estimate

INTERPRETATION (remember : $K_n = \frac{U_{est}}{U_{est} + U_{meas}} = \frac{p_{n,n-1}}{p_{n,n-1} + r_n}$)

- $K_n \approx 0$ when high r_n , small weight to the measurement
- $K_n \approx 1$ when r_n is low and $p_{n,n-1}$ is high, high weight to the measurement

Correction: State update step (cont.)

- Covariance Update Equation:

$$p_{n,n} = (1 - K_n) p_{n,n-1}$$

- the estimate uncertainty is constantly getting smaller but:
 - it is slow when K_n is low (high measurement uncertainty)
 - it is fast when K_n is high (low measurement uncertainty)

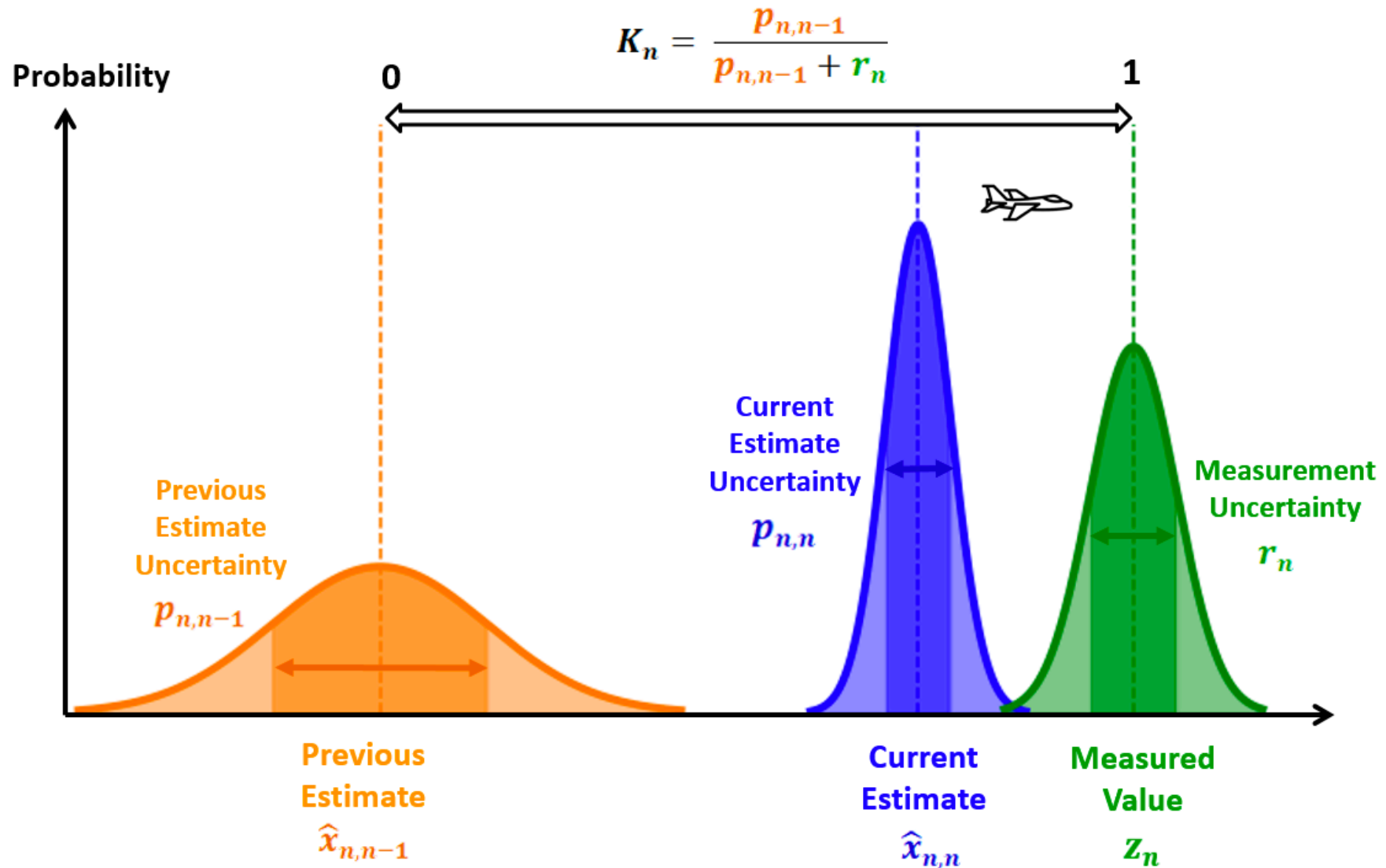
Kalman Gain Intuition

HIGH KALMAN GAIN

due to low measurement uncertainty r_n

$$\hat{x}_{n,n} = \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + K_n(z_n - \hat{x}_{n,n-1})$$

$$p_{n,n} = (1 - K_n)p_{n,n-1}$$



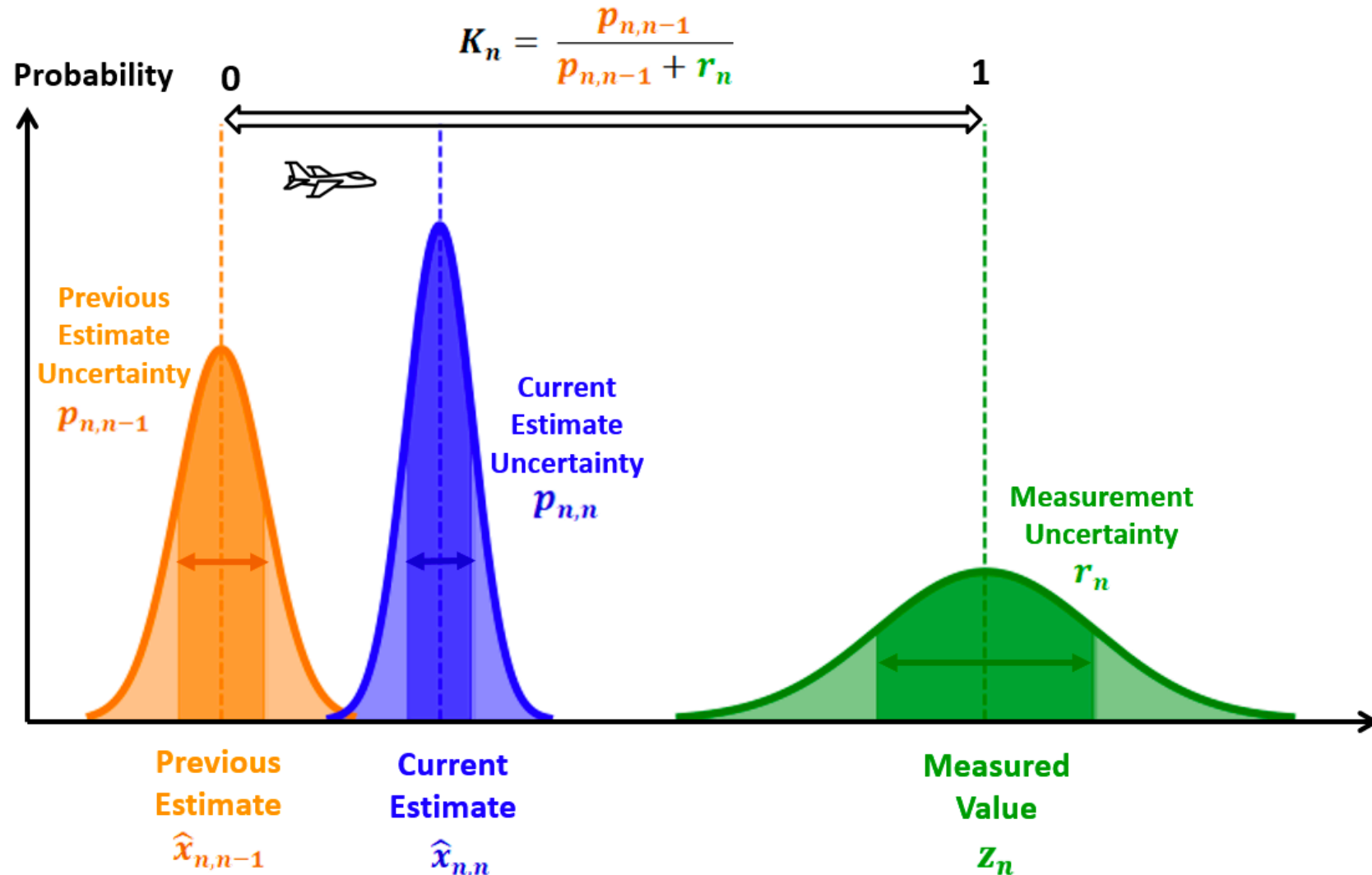
Kalman Gain Intuition

LOW KALMAN GAIN

due to high measurement uncertainty r_n

$$\hat{x}_{n,n} = \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + K_n(z_n - \hat{x}_{n,n-1})$$

$$p_{n,n} = (1 - K_n)p_{n,n-1}$$



Equations of Karman filter (for 1D velocity constant motion)

Equation	Equation Name
$\hat{x}_{n,n} = \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + K_n (z_n - \hat{x}_{n,n-1})$	State Update
$\hat{x}_{n+1,n} = \hat{x}_{n,n} + \Delta t \hat{\dot{x}}_{n,n}$ $\hat{\dot{x}}_{n+1,n} = \hat{\dot{x}}_{n,n}$ (For constant velocity dynamics)	State Prediction
$K_n = \frac{p_{n,n-1}}{p_{n,n-1} + r_n}$	Kalman Gain
$p_{n,n} = (1 - K_n) p_{n,n-1}$	Covariance Update
$p_{n+1,n}^x = p_{n,n}^x + \Delta t^2 p_{n,n}^v + q_n$ $p_{n+1,n}^v = p_{n,n}^v + q_n$	Covariance Prediction

Kalman Filter Scheme

PREDICTION:

(e.g. for constant velocity dynamics)

- State Prediction

$$\hat{x}_{n+1,n} = \hat{x}_{n,n} + \Delta t \hat{\dot{x}}_{n,n}$$

$$\hat{\dot{x}}_{n+1,n} = \hat{\dot{x}}_{n,n}$$

- Covariance prediction

$$p_{n+1,n}^x = p_{n,n}^x + \Delta t^2 p_{n,n}^v + q_n$$

$$p_{n+1,n}^v = p_{n,n}^v + q_n$$

CORRECTION:

- Kalman gain

$$K_n = \frac{p_{n,n-1}}{p_{n,n-1} + r_n}$$

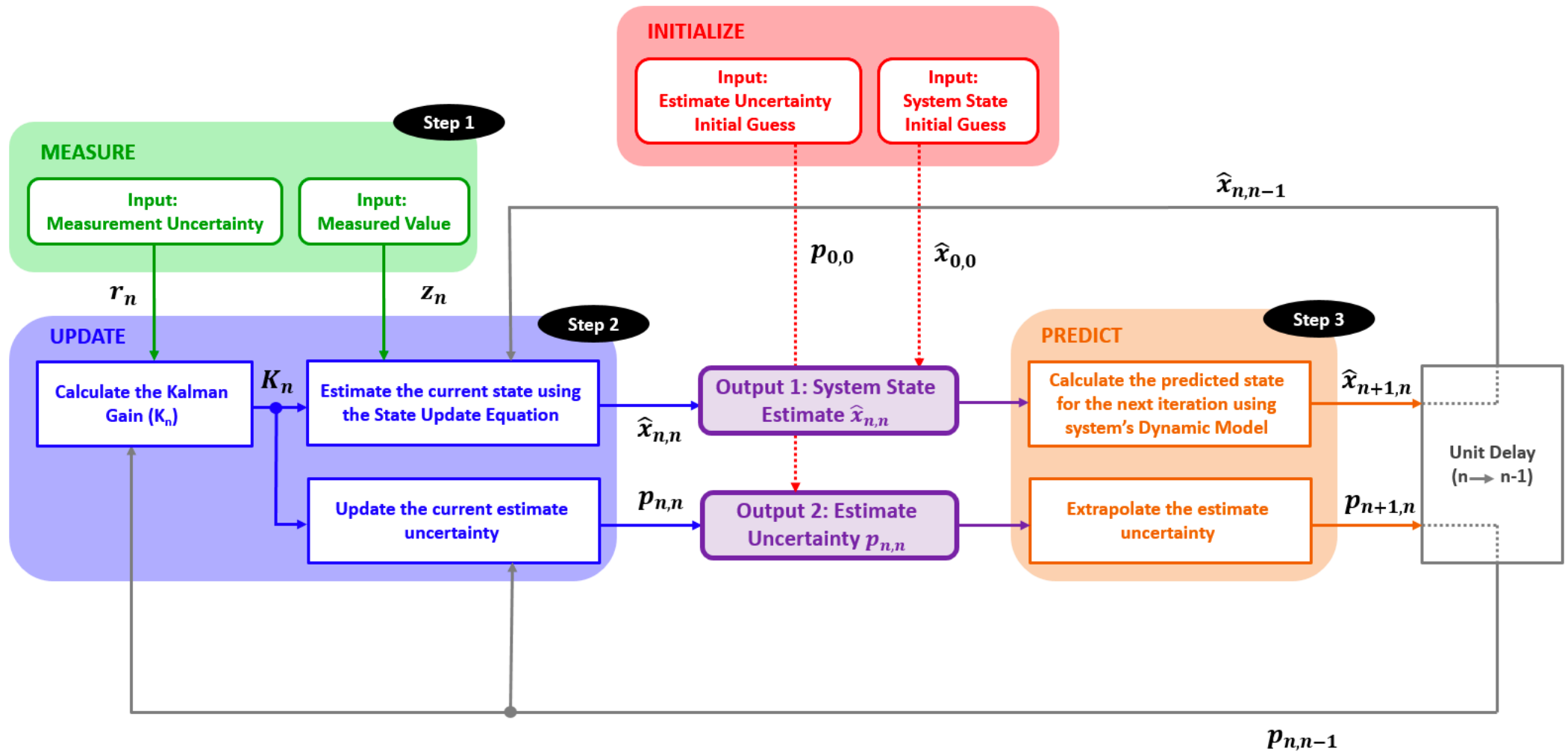
- State update

$$\hat{x}_{n,n} = \hat{x}_{n,n-1} + K_n(z_n - \hat{x}_{n,n-1})$$

- Covariance update

$$p_{n,n} = (1 - K_n)p_{n,n-1}$$

Kalman filter scheme



Reference

Tutorial: <https://www.kalmanfilter.net/default.aspx>

Lab time

- `m02_objDet_Tracking.ipynb`
- `m03_kalman_filter.ipynb`